

Part 2 Documentation: CSS Styling and Responsive Design

Paws Haven Animal Rescue — Website Project

Student Name: Katleho Magano

Student Number: ST10488462

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Introduction

This document explains how each requirement of the WEDE5020 Portfolio of Evidence Part 2 rubric was met during the CSS styling and responsive design phase of the Paws Haven Animal Rescue website project. Each section below corresponds directly to a skill listed in the Part 2 marking rubric.

1. External Stylesheet Created and Implemented in Each Web Page

A single external stylesheet, `style.css`, was created inside a dedicated `css` folder and linked to all five HTML pages (`index.html`, `about.html`, `services.html`, `enquiry.html`, and `contact.html`) using a `<link rel="stylesheet" href="css">` tag placed in the `<head>` of each page.

Using one shared external stylesheet, rather than repeating `<style>` blocks on each page, means any change made to `style.css` automatically applies across the entire site. This was verified by opening each page individually in the browser and confirming that navigation, typography, colors, and layout styling appeared consistently on all five pages.

2. CSS Default Style Code

A CSS reset was included at the top of `style.css` to remove inconsistent default margin, padding, and box-sizing behavior that browsers apply differently, ensuring the site looks the same across Chrome, Edge, and Firefox.

Default/base styles were then set using CSS custom properties (variables) defined in a `:root` block, including a consistent color palette (`--color-primary`, `--color-secondary`, `--color-background`, `--color-text`), a spacing scale (`--space-sum` to `--space-xl`), and a typography scale. Defining these once and reusing them throughout the stylesheet takes advantage of the cascading nature of CSS, meaning the entire site's color scheme or spacing can be adjusted by changing a single variable rather than editing dozens of individual rules.

3. CSS Typography Styles

Typography was styled using `font-family`, `font-size`, `line-height`, and `letter-spacing` properties. Headings (`h1`, `h2`, `h3`) use a serif font paired with the site's primary accent color, while body text uses a clean sans-serif font for readability.

A typography scale was implemented through the `--font-h1`, `--font-h2`, `--font-h3`, and `--font-base` variables, ensuring consistent, harmonious font sizing across every page rather than

arbitrary sizes chosen per element. Paragraph text was also constrained to a maximum line length (max width: 70ch) to keep body copy comfortable to read.

4. CSS Layout Structure

The site's layout was structured using a combination of Flexbox and CSS Grid. The navigation menu and the Adoption page dog listing cards use Flexbox (display: flex, flex-wrap, justify-content) to arrange items responsively in a row that wraps as needed.

CSS Grid (display: grid, grid-template-columns) was used for the homepage's "What We Do" list and the About Us page's Mission/Vision section, arranging content into clean multi-column layouts on desktop screens. A shared <main> container with a max-width and centered margins keeps content consistently aligned across all pages regardless of which page is being viewed.

5. CSS Decoration and Color

A warm, cohesive color palette appropriate to an animal rescue organization was applied consistently using the color variables defined in the base styles: a terracotta primary color for buttons, links and headings, a calm green secondary accent, and a soft cream background.

Decorative styling includes rounded corners (border-radius) on cards, buttons and images, subtle box-shadow effects on the dog's adoption cards, and a colored left border accent on the "Get Involved" section. These decorative choices are applied consistently across every page rather than being one-off, isolated styles.

6. CSS Pseudo-Classes Used

Interactive pseudo classes were implemented to give visual feedback on user interaction.

Navigation links use: hover and: focus to change color and underline interaction, and: active for the moment a link is clicked.

Buttons (the homepage's call-to-action and both forms submit buttons) use: hover to darken on mouse-over and: active to give a pressed-down effect. Form fields (input, select, text area) use: focus to highlight the active field with a colored border and soft glow, making it clear to the user which field they are currently filling in. A: focus-visible state was also added for keyboard navigation accessibility.

7. Responsive Design — Media Queries/Breakpoints for Tablet and Mobile

Two breakpoints were implemented using media queries: a tablet breakpoint at max-width: 768px and a mobile breakpoint at max-width: 480px. These were chosen as they reflect common tablet and phone screen widths.

At the tablet breakpoint, multi-column grid layouts (the "What We Do" list and Mission/Vision section) collapse from two columns into a single column, and heading font sizes reduce slightly. At the mobile breakpoint, the navigation menu switches from a horizontal row to a vertical stack, the hero image height is reduced, dog adoption cards stack to full width, and form buttons expand to full width for easier tapping on a touchscreen. The site was tested by resizing the browser window and using the browser developer tools' device toolbar to simulate tablets and mobile screens.

8. Responsive Design — Adjustment: Layout

The overall page layout adapts across breakpoints: grid-based sections switch from multi-column to single-column, and internal padding/margins reduce at smaller screen sizes using the same spacing variables scaled down within the media queries, so the layout remains visually balanced rather than cramped.

9. Responsive Design — Adjustment: Typography

Heading font sizes are reduced at the tablet breakpoint (--font-h1, --font-h2, --font-h3 are redefined to smaller values within the media query) so that headings do not overwhelm smaller screens, while body text remains legible at every screen size due to the use of relative units (rem) throughout.

10. Responsive Design — Adjustment: Navigation Menu

The navigation menu uses Flexbox with flex-wrap enabled by default, and at the mobile breakpoint the flex-direction changes to column, stacking each navigation link vertically and centring them. This ensures the navigation remains fully usable on a narrow mobile screen instead of wrapping awkwardly or overflowing.

11. Responsive Design — Adjustment: Images

All images use max-width: 100% and are set to display: blocks, meaning they automatically scale down to fit their container on any screen size rather than overflowing or forcing horizontal scrolling. The homepage hero image additionally has its max-height reduced within the mobile

media query, keeping it proportionates on smaller screens while still using object-fit: cover to avoid distortion.

12. GitHub — Project Pushed with Multiple Descriptive Commits

All Part 2 changes, including the creation of style.css and the updated HTML files linking to it, were committed to the project's GitHub repository using descriptive commit messages describing each change (for example, distinguishing the addition of the stylesheet, typography styling, layout structure, and responsive design adjustments as separate, clearly labelled commits).

13. GitHub — README Document Contains All Relevant Information

The README.md file was updated to reflect Part 2, including an updated project overview, the addition of the external stylesheet to the file structure diagram, and confirmation that the site now includes CSS styling and responsive design in addition to the HTML foundation built in Part 1.

14. GitHub — Changelog Section Contains a Record of Development

The README's changelog section was extended with new dated entries covering the Part 2 work: reviewing Part 1 feedback, creating the external stylesheet, implementing base styles and typography, building the layout structure, applying decorative and color styling, adding interactive pseudo-classes, and implementing responsive breakpoints for tablet and mobile.

15. GitHub — References

The README's references section was reviewed and retained alongside the existing Part 1 image and content sources, ensuring the reference list remains accurate and complete for the project going into Part 2.